MONTHLY UPDATE

Gambia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Standards

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity

DPI
Digital Identity and CRVS · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

CAPACITY
Training and skills

INCLUSION
Digital divides

GEOPOLITICS
China activities · EU activities · Gulf/UAE activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATION POLICY 2027-2035

- **MOHERST moves to strengthen science, technology and innovation** — The Standard Newspaper (Gambia), 3 September 2026

  NSTIP 2027-2035 and the STI Bill 2026 validated; three phases and a National Research and Innovation Fund.

Legislation and regulation

COMPETITION AND CONSUMER PROTECTION COMMISSION BILL 2026

- **Parliament Commits Bill to Prohibit Anti-Competitive Practices - Mansa Banko Online** — Mansa Banko Online, 15 September 2026

  Second reading 15 September; repeals the 2007 and 2014 Acts and reaches digital content and distance selling.

Standards

THE GAMBIA STANDARDS BUREAU

- **ISO - TGSB - The Gambia Standards Bureau** — International Organization for Standardization, 3 September 2026

> The Gambia Standards Bureau holds Correspondent, non-voting status at the international standards and electrotechnical organisations, and is the country's technical-barriers enquiry point. A correspondent member may adopt standards; it does not help make them.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

> NINE-DIGIT MOBILE NUMBERING PLAN

- **The Gambia National Numbering Plan Migration Governance and Go-Live Framework, 2026** — Public Utilities Regulatory Authority (PURA), The Gambia, 3 September 2026

  PURA's operational rulebook for the seven-to-nine-digit switch: control centre, eight gates, rollback states.

- **The Gambia National Numbering Plan, 2026** — Public Utilities Regulatory Authority (PURA), The Gambia, 3 September 2026

  Nine-digit E.164 plan for +220, adopted, published and effective 3 September 2026; version 1.0 under the 2009 Act.

- **Africell begins major numbering update** — The Standard, 4 September 2026

  CEO Hussein Diab Ghanem frames the 9-digit migration as growth, not disruption, at a 4 Sep press conference.

- **Gamcel to join the 9-digits migration in second phase** — The Standard, 7 September 2026

  Three Gambian operators moved to nine-digit mobile numbers at midnight, with the fourth to follow in a second phase on a reserved prefix, the regulator confirmed.

- **Gambia opens new chapter in digital growth with nine-digit numbering system** — The Point, 9 September 2026

  Seven-digit numbers retire permanently on 28 February 2027; PURA engaged Meta and the ITU on format recognition.

> INTERNATIONAL CAPACITY ON THE ACE SUBMARINE CABLE

- **Profile – GAMTEL** — Gambia Telecommunications Company Limited (GAMTEL), 21 September 2026

  The Gambian state operator's undated company profile. It says Gamtel has four international gateways on the ACE submarine cable giving 25 Gbps, and a 28 Gbps backup link through Senegal's Free that traffic switches to if ACE fails.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

> IDENTITY RECORDS OF THE FORMER SEMLEX BIOMETRIC ID SYSTEM

- **GID tells court it cannot access Semlex ID data** — Daily Observer (Gambia), 6 October 2026

  A Gambia Immigration Department officer told a court on 6 October that the department can no longer reach data generated under the former Semlex biometric ID system, its access having ended with the contract. That leaves open who holds the historical identity records, although Semlex says it handed the system to the government in March 2024.

- **GID denies losing access to National ID card data** — Gambiana, 13 October 2026

> The Gambia Immigration Department denied losing access to national identity card data, saying the servers used under the former contract remain in the country. It attributed the reports to a misunderstanding of an officer's court testimony.

Registries

> NATIONAL LAND ADMINISTRATION SYSTEM AND LAND INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **'Land Disputes Consume Major Share of Gambia's Judicial Resources,' reveals Minister Bah** — The Voice Gambia, 4 September 2026

  Land disputes 62% of court cases (2026); World Bank consultants' land-information-system draft due end-September.

- **Gov't promises 3-day land lease under new digital system** — The Point, 23 September 2026

  The Gambia's Lands Minister told the National Assembly that lease documents will be issued within three days once the ministry's World Bank-supported digital system is fully running, with contracts already awarded. The ministry is clearing about 50 lease files a week from a backlog in which some had waited three to five years.

> SUPPLEMENTARY VOTER REGISTRATION RECORDS

- **UDP demands full disclosure of supplementary voter data** — The Standard, 5 October 2026

  The Gambia's United Democratic Party asked the electoral commission to explain a gap of 28,932 between the 212,095 supplementary registrations it announced and the 183,163 in the dataset given to the party. It wants the figures before and after de-duplication, the records deleted and the method used, and says it is not alleging malpractice.

Sectoral management information systems

> RED CROSS VOLUNTEER AND MEMBERSHIP MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **GRCS launches digital system to professionalise volunteer, membership management** — The Standard, 2 September 2026

  Paper branch registers replaced by one volunteer database; mobilisation cut from days to minutes.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

> MYGOV DIGITAL SERVICES PLATFORM

- **Gov't steps up to tackle ID card, passport delays** — The Point, 1 September 2026

  MyGov platform to let Gambians apply for ID and passports online; new cards valid 10 years.

> OBJECTIONS TO THE SUPPLEMENTARY VOTER ROLL

- **GAMBIA: IEC Revising Courts Open Voter Register Disputes as Election Credibility Comes Under Scrutiny** — Askani Gambia, 3 September 2026

  Revising Courts sit in nine magistracies on about 1,600 objections; 14,334 double registrations deleted.

> GAMBIA REVENUE AUTHORITY REVENUE COLLECTION DASHBOARD

- **GRA and Liberia Revenue Authority sign deal to deepen digital cooperation** — The Point, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA

  The Gambian account of the Liberia–Gambia revenue dashboard agreement, summarised under the GNN Liberia report. It adds that the LRA pays the expert's airfare while the GRA covers lodging and local transport.

- **LRA to Provide Technical Support for Gambia's Revenue Collection Dashboard** — Global News Network Liberia, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA

  The Liberia Revenue Authority signed a memorandum of engagement to help the Gambia Revenue Authority build a dashboard that tracks revenue collection; it was announced from Accra on 20 September 2026 and signed during meetings of the West African Tax Administration Forum. The help covers a review of GRA's data sources, choice of indicators, design, a prototype, integration and staff training. The LRA will send the developer of its own dashboard to Banjul for an initial three weeks.

DUTY WAIVER APPLICATION SYSTEM

- **Gov't promises duty waiver decision in 72 hrs with new digital system** — The Point, 30 September 2026

  Replaces manual desk-to-desk process; 48 hours at the ministry desk, SMS alerts; part of GRA's 2025-2029 digitalisation.

THREE-YEAR BIOMETRIC DRIVING LICENCE

- **Gambia Begins Rollout of New Three-Year Driving Licence** — Foroyaa, 7 October 2026

  Biometric licence from 7 Oct 2026, D2,550, ends annual renewal; seven centres phased in to 22 October.

ELECTRONIC GOVERNMENT PROCUREMENT SYSTEM

- **GPPA trains procurement cadre on new act, regulations & standard documents** — The Point, 8 October 2026

  Second cohort, 8-10 Oct 2026; 2022 Act, 2024 Regulations, e-GP rollout; new instruments mandatory January 2027.

Capacity

Training and skills

UNIVERSITY ICT PROVISION

- **Information, Technology & Communications – University Of The Gambia** — University of The Gambia, 3 September 2026

  The University of The Gambia's technology school offers three bachelor's degrees plus six-month diplomas in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data science. It is the widest named domestic provision the repository holds for the country.

NATIONAL LABOUR DIGITAL SKILL PROGRAMME

- **MoTIE Signs MoUs to Boost Digital Labour Skills** — New Global Media, 29 September 2026

  Three-year WARDIP digital skills training via USET, Civil Service University and IIHTG; youth, women, disabled.

Inclusion

Digital divides

SMART AFRICA GENDER IMPACT ASSESSMENT TOOLS FOR DIGITAL POLICY

- **Gender checks proposed for digital policies** — Times of Eswatini, 7 October 2026 ESWATINI

  Eswatini's ICT minister, opening the gender impact assessment workshop in Mbabane, said the government wants such assessments built into digital policies and programmes before they are implemented.

- **Gender impact tool targets the digital divide facing women** — FinGuard Magazine, 7 October 2026
  ESWATINI

  A magazine account of the same Eswatini pilot of Smart Africa's gender impact assessment framework, which is meant to test whether digital programmes narrow the divide facing women. It names the tools differently from the ministry's account.

- **Minister Savannah vows to continue advocating for women In tech** — Independent News Eswatini, 7 October 2026 ESWATINI

  Eswatini's ICT ministry and Smart Africa opened a workshop on 7 October to develop and pilot gender impact assessment tools for digital policy, with Eswatini and The Gambia as pilot countries. Three instruments are to be tested on selected digital policies before validation.

Geopolitics

China activities

GAMBIA-GUIZHOU DATA COOPERATION INITIATIVES

- **Ambassador Kah delivers keynote address at China's Big Data Expo 2026, secures landmark cooperation with Guizhou University** — The Point, 4 September 2026

  Four initiatives announced 29 Aug 2026: a Gambian national data laboratory, a CSTD research centre, scholarships.

EU activities

EUROPEAN UNION DIGITAL COOPERATION WITH THE GAMBIA

- **The Gambia - International Partnerships - European Commission** — European Commission, Directorate-General for International Partnerships, 3 September 2026

  The European Commission programmes EUR 193m of grants for The Gambia over 2021-2027, with digitalisation named only as one clause under jobs and growth. The digital share is not stated, against delivered items that are smaller and specific.

Gulf/UAE activities

GULF STATE DIGITAL INVESTMENT IN THE GAMBIA

- **Information & Communications Technology | Sectors | IsDB** — Islamic Development Bank, 3 September 2026

  The Islamic Development Bank records financing the regional fibre backbone reaching The Gambia, alongside two other lenders. No date or sum is given, so the scale of the contribution cannot be stated.

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